

Assignment Title

Project Management and Project Appraisal: Concept and applicability

Instructions:

Follow the following format of Assignment and include case study & Practical questions

Title Page

- Name of University/Institution
- Programme:
- Course/Subject : Project Management
- Assignment Title
- Student Name & ID
- Faculty/Supervisor
- Academic Year
- Date of Submission

Abstract – 150–200 words followed by keywords

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References

- Harvard/APA/required institutional referencing style

Appendices

Case study

1. The project team consisted of a Product Owner, Scrum Master, software developers, UI/UX designers, faculty representatives and student representatives.

The project was divided into two-week sprints.

During Sprint 1, the team developed student registration and login facilities.

During Sprint 2, the course-management module was developed.

During Sprint 3, assignments and quizzes were introduced.

During Sprint 4, attendance and communication features were developed.

At the end of every sprint, the team demonstrated the completed features to faculty and students. Their feedback was incorporated into the next sprint.

Problem Encountered

After the initial launch, students reported that the mobile interface was difficult to use. Under a traditional approach, changing the design at this stage could have caused significant delays. Under Agile, the issue was added to the product backlog and addressed during subsequent sprints.

Outcome

After six months, the university had a functional platform containing the core features. Instead of waiting until the end of the project to obtain user feedback, the team received feedback throughout development. This reduced the risk of developing unwanted features and allowed the university to continuously improve the system.

Questions

1. Why was Agile project management more suitable than a traditional approach for this project?

2. What role did the Product Owner play?
3. Why were two-week sprints used?
4. How did continuous stakeholder feedback improve the project?
5. What risks could have occurred if the university had used a traditional Waterfall approach?
6. How did the product backlog help the project team manage changing requirements?
7. Identify three Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) that could be used to evaluate the project's success.

2. XYZ Retail Ltd. decided to launch an e-commerce platform for selling groceries and household products online. Management wanted the platform operational within four months because competitors were rapidly expanding their online presence.

Initially, the management team prepared a detailed plan covering product listings, payment systems, delivery management, customer accounts, promotional campaigns and mobile applications. However, customer preferences were uncertain, and management recognised that developing the entire system before testing it with customers could result in substantial financial losses.

The company therefore decided to use agile project management.

Project Team

The Agile team consisted of:

- Product Owner – Head of E-Commerce
- Scrum Master – Project Manager
- Software Developers
- UI/UX Designer
- Marketing Executive
- Logistics Representative
- Customer Service Representative

Project Strategy

The team decided to develop a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) first rather than building the complete system.

The project was divided into four two-week sprints.

Sprint 1:

Customer registration, product catalogue and search facility.

Sprint 2:

Shopping cart and online payment system.

Sprint 3:

Order confirmation, inventory management and delivery tracking.

Sprint 4:

Customer reviews, promotional codes and performance improvements.

At the end of each sprint, the team conducted a Sprint Review and demonstrated the product to selected customers.

Major Challenge

During Sprint 2, customer testing revealed that many users abandoned their shopping carts because the payment process required too many steps. The Product Owner considered this a high-priority problem.

Instead of continuing with the original development plan, the team moved the payment simplification requirement to the top of the product backlog. The payment process was redesigned and tested during the following sprint.

Customer testing subsequently showed a significant improvement in the completion of purchases.

Agile Practices Used

The project team used:

- Product backlog
- Sprint planning
- Daily Scrum meetings
- Sprint reviews
- Sprint retrospectives
- Continuous customer feedback
- Prioritisation of high-value features
- Minimum Viable Product (MVP)
- Iterative development

Outcome

The company launched the basic e-commerce platform within four months. Some advanced features were postponed until sufficient customer data became available. This allowed management to focus resources on features that customers actually valued.

The project demonstrated that Agile is not simply about completing tasks quickly; it is about delivering value incrementally, learning from users and adapting the project when requirements change.

Questions

1. Why did XYZ Retail Ltd. choose an agile methodology?
2. What is the purpose of developing an MVP?
3. How did the product backlog help the project team?
4. Why was the payment problem treated as a high-priority requirement?
5. Explain the role of Sprint Reviews and Retrospectives in this project.

6. What would have happened if management had refused to change the original project plan?
7. Calculate the following if the project team completed 32 out of 40 planned user stories during the first four sprints:
 - Completion Rate
 - Incomplete User Stories
8. If the team originally estimated 400 story points and completed 320 story points, calculate the percentage of project work completed.
9. Suggest three additional agile practices that could improve the project.
10. In your opinion, what are the major advantages and limitations of using Agile for e-commerce projects?

Practical Questions

1. Return on Investment (ROI)

A company invests ₹8,00,000 in a new project. During the first year, the project generates a net profit of ₹1,60,000 after all operating expenses and depreciation.

Calculate the Return on Investment (ROI) of the project.

2. Payback Period

A company invests ₹10, 00,000 in a project. The expected annual cash inflows are:

Year	Cash Inflow (₹)
1	2,50,000
2	3,00,000
3	3,50,000
4	2,00,000
5	1,50,000

Calculate the Payback Period of the project.

3. Net Present Value

A company is considering a project requiring an initial investment of ₹12,00,000. The expected cash inflows are:

Year	Cash Inflow (₹)
1	3,00,000
2	4,00,000
3	5,00,000
4	4,00,000

The required rate of return is 10%. Calculate the Net Present Value (NPV) of the project and state whether the project should be accepted based on the NPV criterion.

